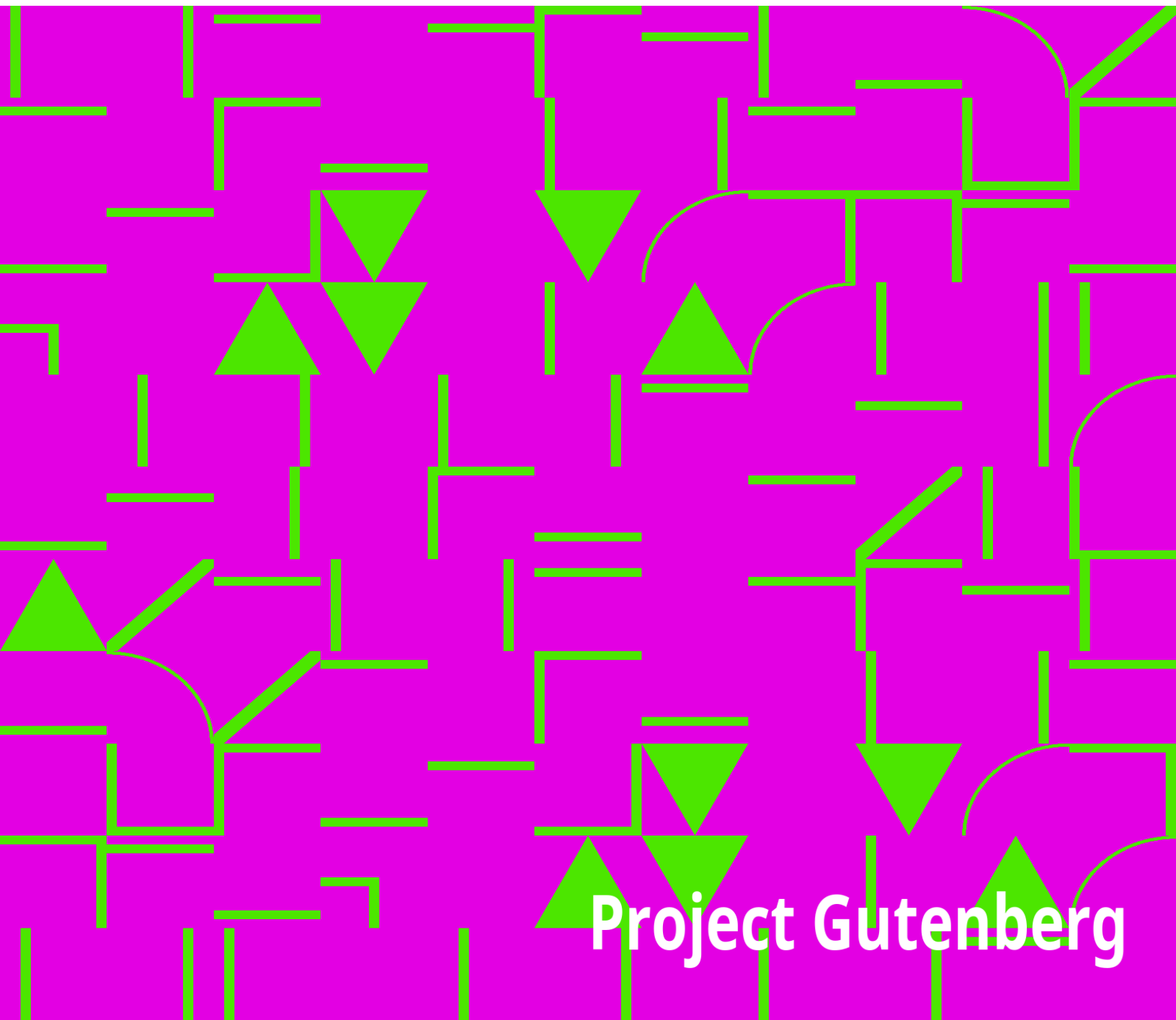


The Doctrine of the Lord's Supper. As Taught by the Church of England

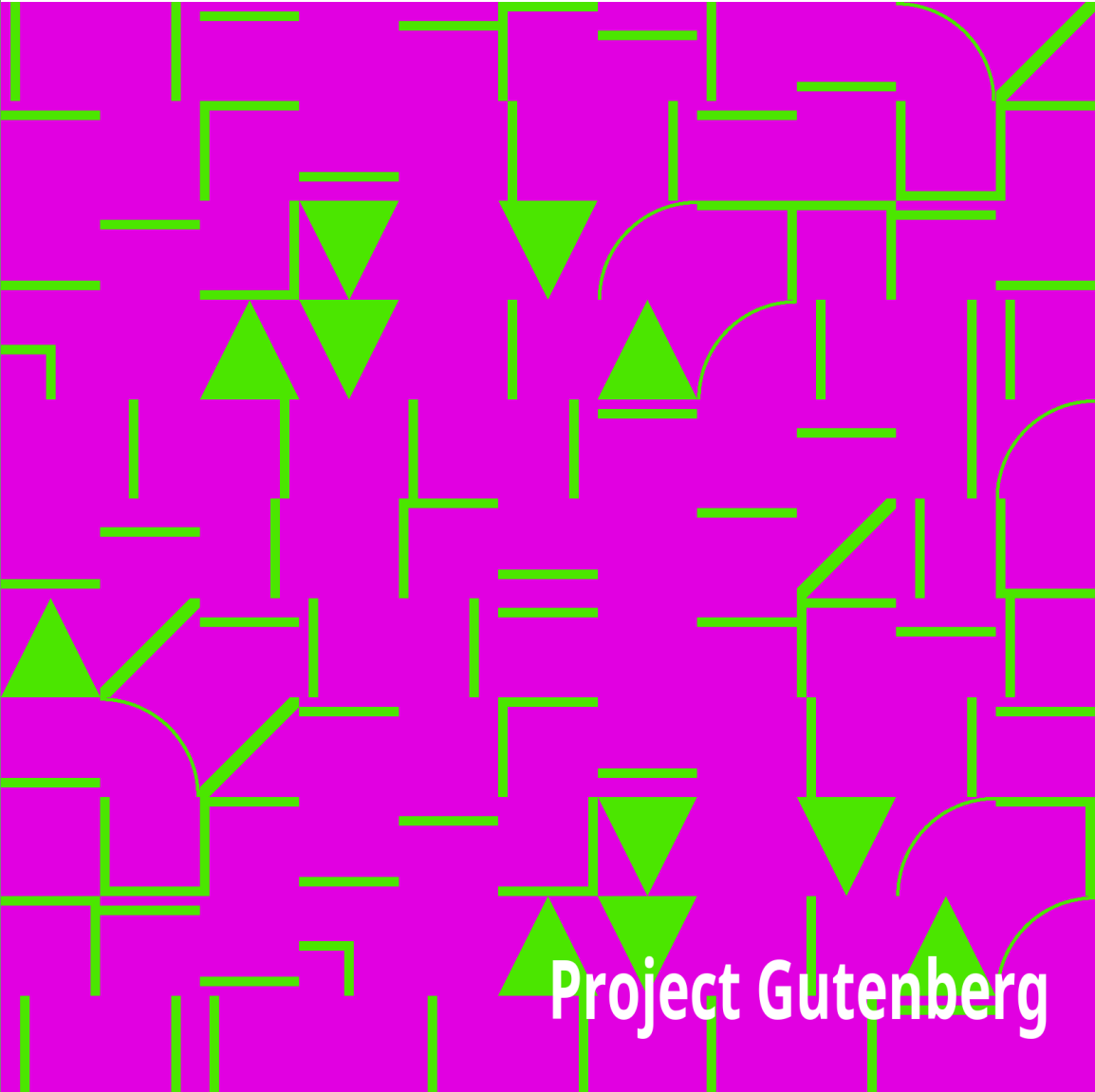
Edward Hoare



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OF THE LORD'S SUPPER. AS TAUGHT BY THE CHURCH OF
ENGLAND ***

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THE DOCTRINE OF THE LORD'S SUPPER.

AS TAUGHT BY

The Church of England.

BY THE
REV. E. HOARE,

VICAR OF TRINITY, TUNBRIDGE WELLS, AND HONORARY CANON OF
CANTERBURY.

LONDON:
HATCHARDS, PICCADILLY.
1877.

INTRODUCTION.

IT is a very easy thing to make a confident assertion, and such assertions produce a greater effect on many minds than the most careful and best-established proof. Thus it is not at all an uncommon thing to hear it asserted with the utmost confidence that what is termed 'The Doctrine of the Real Presence,' is taught by the Church of England; and the result is that a considerable number of persons believe in the assertion, and place reliance on those who make it, as if they, and they only, were the true expositors of the Church's doctrine. In many cases a blind consent is blindly given. The Scriptures are not investigated because the point is supposed to have been settled by the Church, and the documents of the Church are not studied because the doctrine is regarded as beyond the reach of doubt; whereas, if the real groundwork of that opinion were examined, it would be found to consist in nothing more than confident assertion. But those who are loyal to the Church of England ought not to be satisfied with any such representation of its teaching. The issues at stake are far too serious, and, now that after three hundred years of faithful service the Church of England is entering on such a sifting time as she has never yet experienced, it is only fair to her that her own language should be patiently heard, and her own teaching honestly examined. This, then, is the object of this address. I am not about to discuss the teaching of Scripture, but of the Church of England; and my desire is to ascertain by the careful and candid examination of her own documents whether there is, or is not, any authority for the assertion that she teaches what is commonly called 'The Doctrine of the Real Presence.' In doing this, our first business is to ascertain what is the real point at issue, and this is not so easy a task as it may appear, as amongst those who maintain that doctrine there are no authoritative documents on the subject to which we can refer. But, I believe, I am perfectly safe in arranging the three principal points at issue under the three

heads of the Real Presence, Adoration, and Sacrifice; and these three I propose to investigate in that order.

CHAPTER I.

THE REAL PRESENCE.

THIS lies at the foundation of the whole controversy, and to this our first and chief attention must be directed. Now, there can be no doubt on the minds of those who take the Word of God as their true and only guide that it is the sacred privilege of the Children of God to feed by faith on the most precious body and blood of our blessed Saviour. I am not now discussing in what way we feed on Him, or whether His words in the 6th chapter of St. John refer, or do not refer, to the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper. It is my own belief that they do not; but that is not the present question. My present concern is with the fact that, however we explain His words, we are taught by our Lord Himself that such a feeding is essential to our life: 'Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of Man, and drink His blood, ye have no life in you.' Nor can there be any doubt that in 1 Cor. x. 16, 17, the partaking (*κοινωνία*) of the body and blood of Christ is connected with the Lord's Supper. I am not now making any assertion as to the way in which it is connected, for that is the great point to be determined. All that I now say is that there clearly is a connexion, for the words are: 'The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ? For we being many, are one bread and one body; for we are all partakers of that one bread.'

Two things, therefore, seem plain from Scripture: that there is a feeding on the body and blood of our most blessed Saviour, without which none can live, and that the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper is in some way or other connected with that sacred privilege. Thus far, I presume, we are all agreed. But as to the nature of the connexion, there is the widest possible divergence. Rome teaches that by the act of consecration the bread and wine become Christ Himself; that the bread and wine cease to be bread and

wine, and that both the bread and wine become each of them a whole Christ, body, soul, and divinity. The advocates for the doctrine of the Real Presence in the Church of England differ, as far as I can understand them, from Rome in one respect, and one only; namely, that they maintain that the bread and wine do not cease to have the accidents of bread and wine, so that they may still be spoken of as bread and wine, although they have become the body and blood of Christ, or rather Christ Himself. This slight difference is of no practical importance in the discussion, and appears to have been introduced only to avoid the conclusion drawn from those texts which speak of the bread as bread, and the wine as wine, after consecration. The practical conclusion is the same, viz. that our Lord Jesus Christ Himself is in the bread and in the wine. This is what is meant by the expression, 'The real objective presence.' It means that He is present in the elements as a real independent object, without any reference to the character of the recipient, as a book is an independent object in the hand of the man who holds it, without any reference to his state of mind or character. In opposition to this, it is maintained by us who cling to the great principles of the Reformation, that there is no change whatever in the bread and wine, that they are solemnly set apart for sacramental use by means of consecration, but that they remain exactly the same as before consecration, in substance, and accidents, and everything else. That the most precious body and blood of Christ is altogether spiritual food, and that the soul feeds on it by faith, and faith alone. That there are two perfectly distinct kinds of food, the one material, and the other spiritual; the one for the body, the other for the soul; and two perfectly distinct actions; the one of the body eating the bread, the other of the soul feeding on Christ Himself by faith. That the material food is an emblem of the spiritual; and that the act of eating by the body is an emblem of the act of feeding by the soul; and the manner of the two are so far connected by sacramental appointment, that when we receive the emblem we are warranted to expect the enjoyment of the reality. When the body feeds materially on the one, the believer's heart feeds spiritually on the other; but the two acts are distinct, and the one must not be confounded with the other. From this statement it will appear that the point at issue is, whether the precious body and blood of our blessed Lord and Saviour are in the bread and in the wine, so as to be eaten and drunk whenever, and by whomsoever, the elements are received, or whether the spiritual food described in this expression is received by the soul alone

without being localised in the consecrated elements. And my object is to endeavour to ascertain which of these two systems is taught by the Church of England. That dear old Church is at this present time in a position to call forth the deepest anxiety and the most earnest prayers of all those who love the truth. Some are endeavouring to destroy it, some to corrupt it, and some to uphold it in its integrity. In such a state of things it is not fair that the Church should be held responsible for the assertions even of its friends. Its own voice ought to be heard, and its own clear statement carefully studied. I have no intention, therefore, of endeavouring to confuse the subject by a mass of quotations from collateral writers, but will turn at once to those authoritative documents for which the Church has made herself responsible. These are the Articles, Catechism, Liturgy, and Homilies; and these, if it please God, we will examine in order.

The Articles.—There are seven Articles—xxv. to xxxi.—bearing more or less upon the subject; and from these we may gather the real teaching of our Church. The first of them, the twenty-fifth, refers to sacraments in general. ‘Sacraments ordained of Christ be not only badges or tokens of Christian men’s professions, but rather they be certain sure witnesses and effectual signs of grace, and God’s good will towards us, by the which He doth work invisibly in us, and doth not only quicken, but also strengthen and confirm our faith in Him.’ In other words, before men they are badges of our profession, and before God they are signs or witnesses by which God works invisibly in the soul. In this definition there is no idea of any change in the substance of the sign. The sign is not described as being changed into the thing signified, but as being accompanied by it, so that when the believer with the hand and lip visibly receives the sign, it pleases God in His own great grace invisibly to feed the soul and confirm the faith. The visible sign and the invisible gift are therefore kept quite distinct. The one is mercifully granted in connexion with the other, but never said to be incorporated with it, for the sign would cease to be a sign if it were changed into the thing signified. With this definition of a Sacrament, the 27th Article—which describes that of baptism—exactly agrees. It describes it not merely as a badge of a Christian man’s profession, but also declares that it is a sign and means of grace. ‘A sign of regeneration or new birth;’ a ‘means whereby as by an instrument, they that receive baptism rightly (1) are grafted into the

Church; (2) the promises of forgiveness of sin, and of our adoption to be the sons of God by the Holy Ghost, are visibly signed and sealed; (3) faith is confirmed, and grace increased by virtue of prayer unto God.’ But no change is here described as taking place in the water. It is nowhere said to be changed into regeneration. The gifts described are God’s direct gifts to the soul, and are never said to be infused into the element of water. The water is sanctified, or set apart for sacramental use, but the consecration produces no change in its quality or substance. The new birth is not in the water, but is the act of the Holy Spirit moving in the soul. The minister on earth visibly administers the visible sign to the body, and we trust that God in heaven invisibly bestows the invisible gift on the soul. It is not my business now to discuss the connexion between the visible sign and the invisible gift. It is enough for my present purpose to point out that the one is not changed into the other, but that the water remains water, or, in other words, that the sign does not cease to be a sign, as it would do if it were changed into the thing signified.

Now it would be strange indeed if after having first given so perfectly clear a general definition of the general nature of a sacrament, and having so clearly defined baptism, in perfect harmony with that general definition, our Church were afterwards to teach a doctrine respecting the Lord’s Supper, altogether at variance with the general definition, and with her own explanation of the other sacrament. The Church of England includes both sacraments in one definition, and in that definition she never alludes to any change in the sign or elements. In the sacrament of baptism, no one, I believe, would for a moment assert the existence of such a change, even if there were no special Article on the subject. Our conclusion therefore must be, that, according to the Church’s teaching, there is no change in the elements in the Lord’s Supper. As the water in baptism remains water still, so the bread and wine of the Lord’s Supper remain what they were before, plain, simple bread and wine; dedicated, it is true, to the Lord’s service, but altogether unchanged by such dedication.

But we are not left to depend altogether on such conclusions, for there is a special Article on the subject, viz., the twenty-eighth. In the first clause we find the Lord’s Supper described as both sacraments were described in the twenty-fifth, and baptism in the twenty-seventh, as a sign and means of grace. ‘The Supper of the Lord is not only a sign of the love which

Christians ought to have among themselves one to another; but rather is a sacrament of our redemption by Christ's death, inasmuch that to such as rightly, worthily, and with faith receive the same, the bread which we break is a partaking of the body of Christ; and likewise the cup of blessing is a partaking of the blood of Christ.' Having gone thus far in harmony with their general definition, and having quoted the words from 1 Cor. x., our Reformers were clearly brought to the consideration of the very point under discussion, viz., in what way does the soul of the believer partake in the Lord's Supper of the body and blood of his blessed Lord and Saviour? This question they boldly and clearly answer, declaring in the first place, what is not, and in the second place, what is, the truth respecting it. They first declare that it is not by transubstantiation. 'Transubstantiation (or the change of the substance of bread and wine), in the Supper of the Lord cannot be proved by Holy Writ; but is repugnant to the plain words of Scripture, overthroweth the nature of a sacrament' (because if the sign is changed into the thing signified, it ceases to be a sign), 'and hath given occasion to many superstitions.' It would be fruitless to endeavour to trace the sophistry with which those who desire reconciliation of the Church of England with Rome, have endeavoured to avoid the clear statements of this pungent Article. But their conclusion is one which is such an outrage on common sense that it would be utterly ludicrous if it were not inexpressibly melancholy, to see men who, we hope, are devout men, embracing it. We are now deliberately told that the Article was not directed against the doctrine of transubstantiation at all, but against a change for which the name of 'transaccidentation' has been recently adopted. Now I know we live in an age of discovery, but it is difficult for any person of plain common sense, to believe in such a discovery as this. No one who knows anything of the history of the Reformation can be ignorant of the intense eagerness with which the doctrine of transubstantiation was discussed. In books, in sermons, in public disputations, it was argued again and again, by all the most learned theologians of the day. The speculations of the schoolmen as well as the writings of the early fathers were largely quoted. The very distinction now revived between substance and accident was carefully discussed. And men felt so deeply the wide difference between the teaching of Rome and the teaching of Scripture that they could not yield even to save their lives. The stake was before them as the certain issue of their confession, and liberty and honour was the promised reward if only

they would yield. But they had that deep conviction of the deadly error of the doctrine of transubstantiation that they counted it a privilege rather to die than to deny the truth of God. And I put it to any man of common sense and common honesty: is it possible to believe that, after all, there was no real difference between Rome and the Reformers? That Bonner and Gardiner, and Latimer, Cranmer, and Ridley did, in fact, agree; that there might have been a little confusion in some of their minds as to the difference between substance and accident, so that they used the word transubstantiation without knowing its real meaning, but that in all essential points they were agreed, so that the fires of Smithfield were lighted all by mistake, and men who were burned agreed with them that burned them. Clever men and learned men may put forth such a theory, but common sense revolts against it; and all thinking men must agree that, if this be the only theory on which it can be maintained, the doctrine of the Real Objective Presence is not the doctrine of the Church. Plain honest men will be ready to cry ‘shame’ on those who by theological sophistry are endeavouring to evade the plain and incontestable evidence of the great facts of the Reformation. The Reformers knew well enough what Rome meant by ‘transubstantiation,’ and the twenty-eighth Article is decisive on the point that there is no such change in the Supper of the Lord.

But the error having been denied, the next clause of the Article is employed to assert the truth: ‘The body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after an heavenly and spiritual manner; and the means whereby the body of Christ is received and eaten in the Supper is Faith.’ It is most important to observe that word ‘only,’ for it is exclusive of all material feeding. If it were not there it might have been possible to have argued that the Article admits the idea of a material in addition to a spiritual feeding—a feeding with the mouth as well as a feeding with the heart. But the word ‘only’ renders any such theory impossible. There is ‘only’ one manner in which He is received, and that one manner is heavenly and spiritual. With equal clearness it is declared that as there is only one mode in which the body of our blessed Saviour is received, and that heavenly and spiritual; so there is only one mean whereby it is received and eaten, and that one mean is faith. The Article does not speak of *a* means, as if it was one of many but of ‘*the* means’ in order to show that it stands quite alone, that it is only spiritual food, and received only by faith. The lips receive the bread, and

the believing heart receives the spiritual food of Christ Himself. The body feeds on the material food, the soul on the spiritual. The means whereby the body feeds is the same as in common eating, and the means on which the soul feeds is faith.

This important distinction of the outward and inward action is taught with equal clearness in Article xxix.:—‘Of the wicked which eat not the body of Christ in the Lord’s Supper.’ It may seem strange at first sight that any persons should be eager to maintain that the wicked receive so sacred a gift as the body and blood of our blessed Saviour; but a very slight reflection will show the reason, for on this question hinges the whole controversy. If the bread and wine have become the body and blood of the Lord Jesus Christ, or if after consecration He is in them, then it must follow as a matter of certain consequence that whoever eats them eats Him. But if, on the other hand, He is not in the bread and wine at all, but is received by the heart as the bread and wine are by the body, then it follows that if the heart be not right with God, a person may eat the bread, but never feed on the body and blood of our most blessed Lord and Saviour. The whole question whether there is any independent, localized presence of our blessed Redeemer in the elements is involved in the decision whether the wicked in receiving those elements do or do not receive Him. On this point the language of the twenty-ninth Article is perfectly clear:—‘The wicked and such as be void of a lively faith, although they do carnally and visibly press with their teeth (as St. Augustine saith) the sacrament of the body and blood of Christ, yet in no wise are they partakers of Christ; but rather to their condemnation do eat and drink the sign or sacrament of so great a thing.’ In quoting this Article I am not ignorant of the attempt that has been made to represent it as teaching that, although the wicked do eat the body of Christ they do not receive His life-giving blessings. But the Article does not say one word of blessings. It is headed with the words, ‘Of the wicked which eat not the body of Christ.’ It describes the bread as being a sign of the body, and it affirms as clearly as language can affirm that a wicked person may press the sign with his teeth, but still be in no wise either materially, spiritually, with the body or with the soul, a partaker of Christ. According to this Article a person may eat the bread without eating the body of Christ, and receive the wine, but never drink the blood of Christ. If the bread and wine had by consecration become the body and blood, this

clearly would be impossible, for the one being changed into the other, the two would be inseparable, or rather, they would cease to be two, they would be one. It is clear, therefore, that no such change is taught here; and this conclusion is remarkably confirmed by the Rubric at the close of the Service for the Communion of the Sick, for there the same great principle is maintained with equal clearness, only from a different point of view, when it says, 'If a man . . . by just impediment do not receive the Sacrament of Christ's body and blood, the curate shall instruct him that if he do truly repent himself of his sins, and steadfastly believe that Jesus Christ hath suffered death upon the Cross for him, and shed His blood for his redemption, earnestly remembering the benefits he hath thereby, and giving Him hearty thanks therefore, he doth eat and drink the body and blood of our Saviour Christ, profitably to his soul's health, although he doth not receive the Sacrament with his mouth.' I venture to say that nothing can be clearer than the combined testimony of these two most important documents. The Article says, 'That a bad man may receive with his mouth the Sacrament of the body of Christ, but not be partaker of Christ.' The Rubric says that a believer may under certain circumstances eat and drink the body and blood of our Saviour Christ, although he do not receive the Sacrament with his mouth. And if this is not a sufficient proof that according to the teaching of the Church of England, the sign or Sacrament is not changed into the thing signified, I can imagine no proof that can be given. If they are made one by the act of consecration, neither one nor the other can be received alone.

Summing up, then, the teaching of the Articles, we shall arrive at five important conclusions: (1.) A Sacrament is a sign, and a sign would cease to be a sign if it were changed into the thing signified. (2.) In the Sacrament of baptism there is no change in the water. (3.) The doctrine of transubstantiation is condemned as clearly as words can condemn it. (4.) The body of Christ is said to be received only after a heavenly and spiritual manner. (5.) The wicked are declared to be in no wise partakers of the sacred body and blood of our blessed Lord, though with the mouth they eat the sign. And yet, notwithstanding all this, there are those who boldly affirm that the doctrine of the real presence of our blessed Lord and Saviour in the elements is the undoubted teaching of the Church of England.

Catechism.—But is not the doctrine taught in the Catechism? And if we look carefully, shall we not find it there? One writer is so confident that we shall, that he boldly affirms that the Catechism is the final and authoritative decision of the Church on the subject, and must supersede all previous documents; as if five short questions and answers, drawn up for the use of children, were to override the full, dogmatic, and controversial decisions of the Articles. I am not surprised at his wish to draw attention from the Articles, but I am persuaded he will gain nothing by directing it to the Catechism. I have no doubt that the portion of the Catechism relating to the Sacraments is simply an abbreviation, or adaptation, of the Articles. The same arrangement is adopted, and the same definitions occur, in both documents. The first three questions refer to Article xxv., the next to Article xxvii., the next to Article xxviii. The two Sacraments are first included in one common definition. The Sacrament of baptism is then discussed separately, and I presume that no one would venture to affirm that either in the general definition of a Sacrament, or in the particular definition of baptism, the outward sign is ever said to be changed into, or confounded with, the thing signified. In these two definitions they are kept distinct, and if the Catechism teaches any such change in the Lord's Supper, it must make a marked and most important distinction between the two Sacraments, and so neutralize its own general definition, which is carefully drawn to include them both. It would, indeed, be strange if there were such an inconsistency in so short a passage. But, thanks be to God, there is nothing of the kind, and the whole is in perfect harmony both with itself and with the Articles. It is difficult to imagine a clearer and more marked distinction than that expressed in the second and third questions, 'What is the outward part, or sign, of the Lord's Supper?' and 'What is the inward part or thing signified?' The distinctness between the two parts is here more clearly marked than even in the Articles, for in these two questions there is not merely the distinction which we have in them between the sign and the thing signified, but the one is described as outward and the other inward. The one is a material thing, which the recipient may take in his hand, and which is altogether external to himself; the other is inward and invisible, something within the soul, and only seen by the inner man. It is, therefore, utterly contrary to the teaching of these two questions to suppose that both parts of the Sacrament are outward, and that the inward and spiritual grace has a localized, outward presence external to the soul of the recipient.

But though the questions are thus distinct, can we say the same of the answers? The third answer is often boldly appealed to as deciding the question in favour of what is termed the real presence, and as finally settling the whole controversy. But nothing is easier than to make bold assertions of the kind, to persuade men to receive them without the trouble of investigation. But such a system will not satisfy those who desire to know the truth. Let us then examine the answer carefully. ‘What is the inward part or thing signified?’ ‘The body and blood of Christ; which are verily and indeed taken, and received by the faithful in the Lord’s Supper.’ Great stress is sometimes laid on the words, ‘Verily and indeed,’ as if they meant something more than a spiritual feeding on Christ. But there is nothing in them to convey any such idea. All they teach is that there is a real, true gift, really enjoyed and received by the devout communicant; and this we all thankfully believe. The question between us is not whether there is such a gift; but what is its character, and how is it received. The reality of the gift does not prove that it is material, external, or connected in any way with the natural elements. To maintain this would be to deny the reality of anything spiritual and internal. Nothing, therefore, can be proved either way from the words, ‘Verily and indeed.’ They cannot be quoted in opposition to the question to which they are intended as an answer, or in deciding that the inward part is outward. They do assert that the gift of the Lord is no mere fiction or idea, but they do not teach in any way whatever that the sacred gift is in the elements, and external to the soul.

But we have not yet done with this important answer, for there are two more most important points to be noticed in it. In the first place it is clearly stated that it is ‘Verily and indeed taken, and received by the faithful.’ One ingenious writer endeavours to make out that the word ‘faithful’ is here intended to include the wicked. I suppose that we are bound to give him credit for believing what he writes; but it is very difficult for those to do so who read common English in the light of common sense. And still more difficult is it when the Catechism is read in the light of the twenty-eighth Article, from which it was in all probability constructed, and which says, ‘To such as rightly, worthily, and with faith, receive the same, the bread which we break is a partaking of the body of Christ.’ Can any reasonable man compare these passages, and doubt for a moment that by the words

‘the faithful,’ are intended those persons who ‘approach in faith whereby alone they can feed on Christ.’

But there is another point in that same answer which claims our careful consideration. The words are, ‘which are received by the faithful in the Lord’s Supper.’ It does not say, ‘in the Sacrament,’ for if it did it might have been misunderstood. In the use of the word ‘Sacrament’ there is a risk of confusion, for it is employed in three different senses. It is sometimes employed to denote the whole act, or sacramental service, as in Article xxv., where Sacraments are described as badges, witnesses, and signs. It is sometimes used to express the outward sign and the inward gift, regarded as forming together one perfect whole, as in the third question and answer of the Catechism, by which we are taught that there are two parts in a Sacrament—the outward visible sign, and the inward spiritual grace. But sometimes it is used for the outward sign alone, unaccompanied by the spiritual grace, as in Article xxix., where we read that the wicked are in no wise partakers of Christ, ‘but rather to their condemnation do eat and drink the sign, or Sacrament, of so great a thing.’ It is my conviction that this looseness in the use of the word ‘Sacrament’ had led to great confusion; for when those who hold the great doctrines of the Reformation have declared their belief in the presence of their blessed Redeemer in the Sacrament, they have used the word in the sense of the sacred feast, and expressed their assurance that He, a living Lord, is present in the midst of His waiting people. But others, taking the word ‘Sacrament’ to mean simply the consecrated elements, may quote such words from the staunchest reformers, as proving that even they taught the presence of the Lord in the bread and wine. Happily, in the Catechism this danger is avoided, for in this important answer the word ‘Sacrament’ is not used at all. The sacred feast is there called the ‘Lord’s Supper,’ respecting which there is no confusion, and the result is that there is not even the misuse of a word to encourage the idea of anything like a presence in the elements.

But if there were any room for doubt as to the meaning of the Church of England in this passage, it would surely be removed by the next question and answer, ‘What are the benefits whereof we are partakers thereby?’ ‘The strengthening and refreshing of our souls by the body and blood of Christ, as our bodies are by the bread and wine.’ It is difficult to imagine language which could preserve the distinction of the outward and the

inward parts more clearly than this does. The outward is for the body, and strengthens it; the inward for the soul, and does the same for it. The one food is material for a material body; the other is spiritual, for the spiritual sustenance of the soul. The one is external, to be received into the body by bodily organization; the other is internal and invisible, received into the soul by faith. To identify the two, or to shut up the one within the other, is to violate the whole principle of the passage; it is to confuse material and spiritual things, and utterly to depart from the teaching of the Church of England by giving a material character to the most spiritual act of which the soul is capable.

The Communion Service.—But there is yet another most important document, and one inexpressibly precious to the heart of every devout communicant amongst us: I mean the Communion Service, or ‘Order of Administration of the Lord’s Supper, or Holy Communion.’ How often have those sacred prayers expressed the deep feeling of our inmost soul, as we have knelt in holy faith before the Table of the Lord? Now there cannot be a moment’s doubt that we are taught in that most precious Service to feed on the body and blood of our most blessed Saviour, and to expect that the most sacred food will be given to the soul. If this were not expressed, the bread which we break would not be presented to us as a partaking of the body of Christ. But while we are taught in living faith to partake of His most precious body and blood, the whole service has been so carefully worded that the spiritual grace is never identified with the outward sign. As in the Articles and Catechism, the two things are kept perfectly distinct. In simply reading the Service as we now have it, this care is not always apparent, for the language of devotion is never the language of controversial theology, and the spirit of fervent prayer does not admit of the expression of theological distinctions. Full hearts do not stop to define when they are pleading before God. But the utmost care was taken, and we profit from the results. This is easily seen by a comparison of the two Prayer Books of Edward VI. The Reformation was a gradual process, so that the Prayer Book of 1549 is less distinct than that of 1552. In the latter book there were important changes made, and these changes indicate very plainly the real teaching of our present Prayer Book. In the Prayer Book of 1549, there were some passages which might have been understood as

teaching that the most precious body and blood of our Lord was to be received in the consecrated elements of bread and wine; but in the book of 1552, these passages were all changed so as to render such a sense impossible.

For example: in the exhortation to communicants, it was written in the book of 1549, 'He hath left *in* these holy mysteries, as a pledge of His love, and a continual remembrance of the same, *his own blessed body and precious blood* for us to feed upon spiritually to our endless comfort and consolation.' If the word 'mysteries' was understood of the consecrated elements, this passage might have been understood as teaching that the spiritual food was actually in the consecrated bread and wine. So in 1552, the passage was changed to the well-known words, 'He hath instituted and ordained holy mysteries as pledges of His love, and continual remembrance of His death, to our great and endless comfort,' and all possibility of misapprehension was removed.

Again, in the prayer of consecration in 1549 we find the words, 'Hear us, O Merciful Father, we beseech thee; and with Thy Holy Spirit and Word vouchsafe to bless and sanctify these Thy gifts and creatures of bread and wine, that they may be unto us the body and blood of Thy most dearly beloved Son Jesus Christ.' These words might fairly be taken as praying for a change in the elements, and therefore in the next version the passage was completely changed, and the unmistakable language of our present Prayer Book introduced in its stead: 'Grant that we receiving these Thy creatures of bread and wine, according to Thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ's holy institution, in remembrance of His death and passion, may be partakers of His most blessed body and blood.'

So in the prayer before consecration. In the first book the words were, 'Grant us, therefore, gracious Lord, so to eat the flesh of Thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and to drink His blood *in these Holy Mysteries*.' But this was liable to the same danger as the passage in the exhortation already referred to, and therefore the words, 'In these holy mysteries,' were struck out, and the prayer left as it now stands in our Prayer Book.

And so once more, in the words of administration in the first book there was only the first portion of the present sentences. The words were: 'The body

of our Lord Jesus Christ, which was given for thee, preserve thy body and soul unto everlasting life.’ But though not necessary, it was possible to understand this as if the bread presented to the communicants were declared to be the body of our Lord Jesus Christ. To prevent this, the following words, ‘Take and eat this, and feed on *Him in thy heart by faith*, with thanksgiving,’ were substituted in 1552, and combined with the original form in 1559. Nothing can be clearer, or more important, than the teaching of this passage. In it the distinction is perfectly clear between the bread which we eat, and the blessed Saviour on whom we feed. Of the bread it says, ‘Eat this,’ this bread which I put into your hand. But of the inward and spiritual grace it says, ‘Feed on Him,’ on the Lord Jesus Christ Himself; and this feeding is described as the act of the heart through faith, for the words are, ‘Feed on *Him*—in thine heart—through faith—with thanksgiving.’

Homilies.—But there is another rich mine of truth from which those who are anxious to learn the mind of the Church of England may obtain most abundant information. I observe that as a general rule those who teach the doctrine of the real presence in the elements refer very little to the Homilies. They treat them as if they were not aware of their existence, and I am not surprised at their silence, for they certainly can find nothing in them to support their system. You may search the Homilies from one end to the other, and you will find nothing there to support the doctrine of a real presence of our Lord and Saviour in the consecrated elements. They are in perfect harmony with the Articles. The definition of a Sacrament is the same, and preserves with equal clearness the distinction between the outward sign and inward grace—as *e.g.*, in the ninth Homily of the second book, where we read the following reference to the words of Augustine ‘He calleth Sacraments holy signs, and . . . saith “if Sacraments have not a certain similitude of these things whereof they be Sacraments, they should be no Sacraments at all. And of this similitude, they do for the most part receive the names of the same things they signify.” By these words of St. Augustine, it appeareth that he allowed the common description of a Sacrament, which is that it is a visible sign of an invisible grace, that is to say, that setteth out to the eyes, and other outward senses, the inward

working of God's free mercy, and doth as it were seal in our hearts the promises of God.'

But I must be careful with reference to the Homilies, for there are two passages which are sometimes quoted in order to show that the doctrine of the real presence in the elements is the doctrine taught in them. One of these passages is quoted by Dr. Pusey in his book on the Real Presence, viz., the Advertisement at the end of the First Book of Homilies: 'Hereafter shall follow sermons of fasting, praying, almsdeeds, &c, of the nativity, passion, resurrection, and ascension of our Saviour Christ; of the due receiving of His blessed body and blood under the form of bread and wine,' &c. Now I am quite prepared to admit that when this Advertisement was written, the writer of it did believe that the body and blood of our blessed Lord was present under the form of bread and wine; but even the Advertisement was no part of any Homily, and can never be regarded as having been at any time a portion of the authoritative teaching of the Church of England. I am willing, however, to admit that, although not authoritative, it may be regarded as indicating what was the opinion of the writers at the date of the First Book of Homilies. All, therefore, turns upon the date, and when I remember that the First Book of Homilies was published in 1547, two years before the first revision of the Communion Service, viz., that in 1549, and five years before the second, viz., that in 1552, when the alterations to which I have referred were made in the Communion Service; when, moreover, I find that when the promised Homily was published, it was headed by a different title, viz., 'The worthy receiving, and reverend esteeming; of the Sacrament of the body and blood of Christ;' when, moreover, I find on its first page the passage just quoted respecting the sign and thing signified, I am altogether at a loss to understand how a person of the learning of Dr. Pusey should have quoted the Advertisement, as if it were the teaching of the Church of England in her Homilies. He must have known the date, and must have been perfectly acquainted with the changes which took place five years after it.

But there is another passage sometimes quoted from the Homily, and quoted with great assurance by those who desire to represent the Church of England as teaching the doctrine of the real presence. I once heard an advanced Ritualist preaching on the subject, and with the utmost boldness he challenged us to listen to the Homilies, and then he quoted the words,

‘Thus much we must be sure to hold, that in the supper of the Lord there is no vain ceremony, no bare sign, no untrue figure of a thing absent, but, as the Scripture saith, a marvellous incorporation.’ Oh! how did my heart burn, as I sat in that church, to cry aloud from my seat ‘Read the whole passage,’ but I was obliged to sit in silence, and endure. Oh! how I pity laymen, who have no power of contradiction, when they hear gross error preached to themselves and their families! But I may read it now: ‘The table of the Lord, the bread and cup of the Lord, the memory of Christ, the annunciation of His death, yea, the communion of the body and blood of the Lord’ (why was all that left out?), ‘In a marvellous incorporation.’ Now what is the meaning of this marvellous incorporation? Does it mean the incorporation of our blessed Lord and Saviour in the bread? Or does it refer to the work of the Holy Ghost in the soul? Let the question be decided by the words which conclude the sentence: ‘In a marvellous incorporation, which, by the operation of the Holy Ghost—the very bond of our conjunction with Christ—is through faith wrought in the souls of the faithful.’

But that is not all. The Homilies were written by men deeply impressed by the truth of God: by men who loved the Gospel, and who earnestly desired to see others partakers of their joy. So they did not merely speak in the language of accurate theology, but they appealed to souls with the fervour of loving hearts. Let us listen, in conclusion, to the glowing words with which they wind up the first part of their address, ‘It is well known that the meat we seek for in this supper is spiritual food; the nourishment of our soul; a heavenly refection and not an earthly; an invisible meal and not bodily; a ghostly substance and not carnal; so that to think that without faith we may enjoy the eating and drinking thereof, or that that is the fruition of it, is but to dream a gross carnal feeding, basely objecting and binding ourselves to the elements and creatures.’ . . . ‘That when thou goest up to the reverend Communion to be satisfied with spiritual meats, thou look up with faith upon the holy body of thy God, thou marvel with reverence, thou touch it with the mind, thou receive it with the hand of thy heart, and thou take it fully with thy inward man. Thus we see, beloved, that resorting to this table, we must pluck up all the roots of infidelity, all distrust in God’s promises, that we make ourselves living members of Christ’s body. For the unbelievers and faithless cannot feed upon that precious body. Whereas the

faithful have their life, their abiding in Him, their union, and, as it were, their incorporation with Him. Wherefore let us prove, and try ourselves unfeignedly without flattering ourselves, whether we be plants of that fruitful olive, living branches of the true vine, members indeed of Christ's mystical body, whether God hath purified our hearts by faith, to the sincere acknowledging of His Gospel, and embracing of His mercies in Christ Jesus, so that at this, His table, we receive, not only the outward Sacrament, but the spiritual thing also; not the figure, but the truth; not the shadow only, but the body; not to death, but to life; not to destruction, but to salvation; which God grant us to do through the merits of our Lord and Saviour: to whom be all honour and glory for ever. Amen.'

CHAPTER II.

ADORATION.

THUS far I have examined into the teaching of the Church of England with reference to nothing but the bare doctrine of transubstantiation, or, as it is now more frequently called, of the real objective presence of the body and blood of our blessed Saviour in the consecrated elements of bread and wine. I have not discussed the question whether the elements of bread and wine remain either in their substance or their accidents, for these questions are not discussed by the Church of England. The point maintained by the Church is that the most precious body and blood of Christ are not in the bread and wine at all, but are given by the direct action of the Holy Ghost to the soul of the believer, and received by him through faith. But we cannot leave the subject there, for, as we are taught in the twenty-eighth Article, that doctrine ‘has given occasion to many superstitions,’ and to two of these, adoration and sacrifice, we must, if we would gather the real teaching of the Church of England, direct our careful study.

Adoration.—When we speak of adoration, let it not be for one moment supposed that we refer to the adoration of the Lord Jesus, as now seated at the right hand of God, for with the whole heart, and the most profound reverence, we would fall at His feet, and say, in the language of our Communion Service, ‘Thou only art Holy, Thou only art the Lord; Thou only, O Christ, art most high in the glory of God the Father.’ The adoration against which we protest is the adoration of the Lord Jesus Christ as supposed to be localised in the consecrated elements of bread and wine. Such adoration must, of course, involve the belief that He, as a living Lord, is actually present in each piece of consecrated bread, and also in the consecrated wine, and for such a belief there is not one word in Scripture. The doctrines of transubstantiation and consubstantiation are made to rest on what is called the literal interpretation of the words, ‘This is My body,’

‘This is My blood;’ but the utter inconsistency of the whole system is shown by the fact that while its advocates maintain that these words must be taken literally, and that their doctrine of the real presence is the necessary consequence, they themselves completely depart from their own principle of literal interpretation, and make a bold assertion which the words, taken literally, distinctly contradict. The words taken literally could certainly teach nothing more than that the bread becomes the body, and the wine the blood of our blessed Redeemer; but Rome teaches, and as far as I can learn the modern Ritualists teach the same, that not only do the bread and wine each separately become the body and blood, but that each of them becomes by the act of consecration a complete living Saviour, with Body, Soul, and Divinity; so that there is a living Saviour in each piece of consecrated bread, and a living Saviour in the cup, and that these living Saviours are to be adored or worshipped with the same worship as is given to our blessed Redeemer at the right hand of the throne in Heaven. I could give scores of passages in proof of my statement; but the well-known words of Mr. Bennett are sufficient: ‘I am one of those who have lighted candles at the altar in the day-time, who use incense at the holy sacrifice—who use the Eucharistic vestments—who elevate the blessed Sacrament—who myself adore, and teach the people to adore, the consecrated elements, believing Christ to be in them—believing that under their veil is the sacred body and blood of my Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.’ Such is the fabric raised on what is called the literal interpretation of the words of our blessed Saviour, a fabric for which those words taken literally give no foundation of any kind whatever. But how is it with the Church of England? Are men true Churchmen when they elevate the elements for worship? Are they teaching the doctrines of the Church of England when they teach that we are to worship the living Lord in the bread and in the cup which the priest raises above his head for adoration? It certainly does not seem as if they were, for as far as I have been able to discover, not one word from all our Church’s documents is ever quoted in support of the practice. The only position taken up is that it is not expressly forbidden, and this position I believe to be, like the rest of the system, without foundation. It is quite true that comparatively little is said, for the doctrine of transubstantiation being denied and disproved, all the rest follows as a matter of course. If there is no real objective presence there can be no adoration. If a living Saviour be not in the elements He cannot therein be adored. The whole controversy

turns on the doctrine of the Real Presence as the key-stone of the system. But though the subject has not been so fully discussed in our Church documents, there is quite enough to show very clearly the mind of the Church of England. The concluding words of Article xxviii. are quite enough to settle the question: 'The Sacrament of the Lord's Supper was not by Christ's ordinance reserved, carried about, lifted up, or worshipped.' How, with that Article before them, clergymen of the Church of England can presume to elevate the sacramental elements for worship I am at a loss to explain. But this is not all that has been said, for the practice of kneeling at the Lord's Supper occasioned at one time a certain amount of anxiety in the minds of some persons, as they feared that it might be mistaken for adoration of the host. To prevent the possibility of any such mistake a most important note was added in the year 1552, which, after having been omitted in 1559, was restored with a slight alteration in 1662. It is as follows: 'It is hereby declared, that thereby no adoration is intended, or ought to be done, either unto the sacramental bread or wine there bodily received, or unto any corporal presence of Christ's natural flesh and blood. The sacramental bread and wine remain still in their very natural substances, and, therefore, may not be adored (for that were idolatry to be abhorred of all faithful Christians); and the natural body and blood of our Saviour Christ are in Heaven, and not here; it being against the truth of Christ's natural body to be at one time in more places than one.' Such words as those need no comment, and I should be only wasting time if I were to stop to discuss them. Of course people endeavour to evade them; but the attempts at evasion only tend to show the utter helplessness of the undertaking. The memorialists already referred to, say, 'We repudiate all adoration of a corporal presence of Christ's natural flesh and blood, that is to say, of the presence of His body and blood as they are in Heaven.' They admit it, therefore, in some other way. But the Church of England denies it altogether. It draws no nice distinction as to the mode, but simply denies the fact, and settles the question once and for ever for all honest men whose honest desire it is to teach its doctrines and adopt its worship.

But as we really desire to ascertain the truth, it is well to refer to the statements of those who differ from us. I turn, therefore, to those of Dr. Pusey, as I believe he is the person who above all others would be regarded as the best exponent of the theory of the Real Presence and its

consequences. In his book, *The Real Presence*, p. 311, he says: 'The Church of England has maintained the same reserve as to the practice of adoring our Lord present in the Eucharist.' And again: 'With regard to the adoration we are rather told that the Sacraments were not ordained of Christ to be adored, but to be received.' I could not wish for a plainer statement of truth than those last words, but I confess myself at a loss to understand how the writer can teach adoration, and yet continue in his position as a clergyman of the Church of England. But with the former words I cannot agree, for the Church of England has not exercised reserve. To exercise reserve is to keep in the background a truth which we believe, but which from motives of expediency we think it better not to make known. But there is no such reserve in the Church of England. She is plain, honest, and outspoken for the truth; and when she struck all trace of adoration from her worship she did so, not from any crafty policy of reserve, but because she believed that the whole thing was a gross superstition, and with a firm, bold, and unsparing hand she cut away the whole fabric, and left no trace of it in the whole system of her worship. There was no reserve in the Reformers, whatever there may be in those who are striving to undo the Reformation.

CHAPTER III.

SACRIFICE.

BUT adoration is not all, for there is yet a further result of the doctrine of the real objective presence, if possible, more dangerous even than adoration; I mean the assertion of a continued sacrifice. It is extremely difficult to ascertain exactly what is held by the Ritualistic party, for there is no document to which they all subscribe or for which they can be held responsible; but there is quite enough to show that a great number amongst them are teaching without reserve that there is in the Lord's Supper a continuation, or repetition, of the propitiatory sacrifice of our blessed Lord. The extent to which this is carried may be gathered from a book called the *Eucharist Manual*, to which Archbishop Longley drew the attention of the Church in the year 1867, in which it is said that 'a real, true, and substantial sacrifice is offered to God the Father, and not merely a spiritual or metaphorical sacrifice;' that the Holy Eucharist is 'a true, real, and substantial sacrifice offered to God the Father, offered for the quick and the dead;' the meaning of which statement is proved beyond the possibility of a doubt by the following prayers: 'Eternal Father, I offer thee the precious blood of Jesus Christ, in expiation of my sins, and for the wants of the whole Church;' and 'I now join Thy minister in offering Thee this oblation of the body and blood of Thy Son, in propitiation for my numberless sins, and for the salvation of all bound to me by kindred or affection.' Nothing would be easier than to bring together almost any number of similar passages, and I feel persuaded that I am not misrepresenting the principles of the writers when I say that they teach the continuation or repetition of the sacrifice of our blessed Lord Himself as a propitiation for sin. Now is this the teaching of the Church of England, or is it not? Dr. Pusey's own language may, I think, decide the question. In his book, on the *Real Presence*, p. 311, he says of the Church's documents: 'Although the great act of Eucharistic Sacrifice remains in the consecration itself, and it has

been all along an object of belief in the Church of England, it is mentioned only when we pray to God to accept this our sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving.’ This then is the only passage in all the documents of the Church of England which we may presume can be produced as being in favour of this teaching, and I venture to say that Dr. Pusey is far too good a theologian not to know that the passage is dead against the doctrine of propitiatory sacrifice. Is it possible to suppose that such a learned man as he is does not know the distinction between a sacrifice of expiation and a sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving, between an atonement for sin and the free-will offering of a thankful and loving heart? And is it possible that there should be one moment’s doubt as to the teaching of the Church of England, when the words, which he himself acknowledges, are the only words which he can discover in support of the one are words which beyond all controversy refer exclusively to the other?

But is the Church of England as silent as he appears to consider it on this important subject? Are we left to gather its great principles from that one passage in the Communion Service? Does it teach nothing on the subject of propitiatory sacrifice but in that one short sentence which has in fact no connexion with it? The whole of the Church of God depends on a completed propitiation, and we might well tremble for the Church of England if that one great central fact were altogether out of sight in its teaching. But, thanks be to God! it is not thus ignored, for this is just one of those points for which our Reformers were called to suffer, and respecting which they were most explicit.

To begin with the Articles. The thirty-first consists of three parts. (1.) The perfect sufficiency of the great propitiation for sin. ‘The offering of Christ *once* made’ (observe the *once*) ‘is that perfect redemption, propitiation, and satisfaction for all the sins of the whole world, both original and actual.’ (2.) The declaration that in consequence of that sufficiency there can be no further propitiation. ‘There is none other satisfaction for sin, but that alone.’ (3.) The condemnation of the pretended sacrifice of the mass. ‘Wherefore the sacrifice of masses, in the which it was commonly said that the priest did offer Christ for the quick and dead, to have remission of past guilt, were blasphemous fables and dangerous deceits.’ I am not ignorant that an attempt has been made to represent this Article as referring to the abuses which had gathered around the sacrifice of the mass, and not against

the principle of sacrifice itself. As I should be extremely sorry to misrepresent the opinions of those who differ from me, I quote Dr. Pusey's words as I find them in his *Eirenicon*, p. 25: 'The very strength of the expressions used, of "the sacrifices of masses," that they were blasphemous fables and dangerous deceits, the use of the plural, and the clause "in which it was commonly said," show that what the Article speaks of is not the sacrifice of the mass, but the habit (which, as one hears from time to time, still remains) of trusting to the purchase of masses when dying, to the neglect of a holy life, or repentance, and the grace of God and His mercy in Christ Jesus while in health.' To what desperate shifts are persons driven who would endeavour to represent the Church of England as teaching the sacrifice of the mass! The Article declares the sufficiency and finality of the one sacrifice of our blessed Lord and Saviour, and because that one sacrifice is sufficient and final, it condemns in the strongest possible language the opinion current at the time, that in some form or other there was a repetition of sacrifice in the mass. But because the language is strong, because there is an allusion to the current opinion, and because the plural number is employed so as to comprehend the numberless sacrifices supposed to be offered on the numberless altars of the Church of Rome, therefore it is argued that the Article does not refer to the doctrine of sacrifice at all, but simply to the purchase of the mass in the dying hour, instead of repentance and faith during the life. If the Article were meant to condemn the purchase of masses, it is very strange that it makes no allusion to the subject; and if it aimed at the neglect of repentance and faith, it is most extraordinary that neither repentance nor faith is once mentioned in its words. Our Reformers were very plain-spoken men, and it appears from the strength of their language that they meant to be plain-spoken in the Article. It is very strange if, after all, while they appeared to condemn one thing, they were really condemning another, and did it in such unintelligible language that their meaning was not discovered till three hundred years after the Article was written.

In the Catechism there is not much said on the subject, but that little is decisive. There is only one allusion to sacrifice, and that is, to the one sacrifice of our blessed Saviour, while the Lord's Supper is distinctly declared to be an act of remembrance of that great event. 'Q. Why was the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper ordained?' 'A. For the continual

remembrance of the sacrifice of the death of Christ, and of the benefits which we receive thereby.' It is needless to stop to point out that remembrance cannot mean either continuation, repetition, or application; and with such a distinct passage before us, it is manifest that no one can claim the Catechism as teaching the doctrine of propitiatory sacrifice in the Lord's Supper. There is an opinion in some minds that the language of the Catechism is less distinctly Protestant than that of the other documents. That opinion I believe to be thoroughly mistaken, and it certainly is very difficult to understand by what perversion of language the doctrine of propitiatory sacrifice can be wrung from such language as 'The continual remembrance of the sacrifice of the death of Christ,' and a 'thankful remembrance of His death,' as we find in the answer with which the Catechism concludes.

From the Catechism let us turn to the Communion Service. And here we are met at the outset by Dr. Pusey's remarkable admission, that the only passage teaching the doctrine is the language of thankful dedication in the prayer that follows the reception: 'We, Thy humble servants, entirely desire Thy Fatherly goodness mercifully to accept this our sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving.' No person who understands the difference between propitiation and thanksgiving can fail to see at a glance that there is no reference in this passage to propitiatory sacrifice. The next sentence is: 'Here we offer and present unto Thee, O Lord, ourselves, our souls and bodies, to be a reasonable, holy, and lively sacrifice unto Thee.' 'Ourselves, our souls and bodies,' what are they to make a propitiation for sin? Nothing can be plainer than that the prayer is intended to be the language of the thankful heart surrendering itself as a thank-offering to God. If the language admitted of the smallest doubt, that doubt would be removed by the position assigned to it in the Communion Service of 1552. In that of 1549 it stood with certain additions before the administration of the sacramental elements, but the human mind is so prone to misunderstand the simplest documents, that our Reformers, to avoid all possibility of mistake, first removed from the prayer any expressions which they thought could be misunderstood, and then placed it after, instead of before, the reception of the elements. Thus they secured that there should be no room for doubt that the sacrifice referred to is the surrender of self, and the motive for that surrender, not the desire for forgiveness, but the deep

gratitude of a thankful heart, when sin has been blotted out through a finished atonement, and the appropriation of that atonement has been sealed to the soul by the sacred emblems of His body and blood.

But these were not the only changes made in the Communion Service of 1552. There was another of a most important character in connexion with the subject of sacrifice. You never hear of sacrifice without an altar. The altar is, in fact, an essential adjunct of sacrifice, and accordingly in former times there was an altar, generally made of stone, against the eastern wall of the chancel. Accordingly in the Communion Service of 1549, there is frequent mention of the altar; but in 1552 all altars were abolished. There is no allusion to an altar now in any document of the Church of England. When persons speak of leading brides to the altar, they are not using the language of the Church, nor are they presenting the holy rite of marriage in a very happy aspect, for the expression really implies that the poor bride is led to sacrifice. There is now nothing but a table known in the Church of England. The altar has been removed, and the table introduced, in order that all might see even in the Church's furniture, that the doctrine of sacrifice has been abandoned, and that the doctrine of communion is the true creed of the Church of England. It may be sufficient to refer to the fourth rubric as a specimen of the changes made. In 1549 it was, 'The priest standing humbly afore the midst of the altar shall say,' &c. In 1552, 'The table having at the Communion time a fair white linen cloth upon it, shall stand in the body of the church or in the chancel, where Morning Prayer and Evening Prayer be appointed to be said. And the priest standing at the north side of the table shall say,' &c.

And now for the Homilies, the last authority to which we have to refer in this inquiry. I am not surprised that those who maintain the doctrine of a continuation of propitiatory sacrifice preserve a prudent silence with reference to the Homilies. I do not know of any one passage ever quoted by them in support of their opinions, while every allusion to the subject in the Homilies is of a distinctly opposite character. Let us turn to one or two passages from the 15th Homily of the Second Book. In the first page of that Homily we have a general description of the Sacred Feast. 'Amongst the which means is the public celebration of the memory of His precious death at the Lord's Table: which, although it seems of small virtue to some, yet being rightly done by the faithful, it doth not only keep their weakness,

but strengtheneth and comforteth their inward man with peace and gladness, and maketh them thankful to their Redeemer with diligent care and godly conversation.’ Here we have the description of the same two purposes as are mentioned in the Articles and Catechism, but not one syllable respecting sacrifice, for no one who values correctness in language can maintain that memory is continuation, or that the memory of His precious death can be a renewed act of propitiation. But this may be thought to be only an omission. Let us pass on then to the following page, when we read, ‘For as that worthy man, St. Ambrose, saith: “He is unworthy of the Lord that otherwise doth celebrate that mystery than it was delivered by Him. Neither can he be devout that otherwise doth presume that it was otherwise given by the Author.” We must, therefore, take heed lest of the memory it be made a sacrifice; lest of a Communion it may be made a private eating; lest of two parts we have but one; lest in applying it for the dead we lose the fruit that be alive.’ In the Homily for Whit Sunday, the self-same truth is taught, with almost equal clearness. When it is said of the Church of Rome that they ‘have so intermingled their own traditions and inventions, by chopping and changing, by adding and plucking away, that now they (the Sacraments) may seem to be converted into a new guise. Christ commended to His Church a Sacrament of His body and blood; they have changed it into a sacrifice for the quick and the dead.’ And yet notwithstanding all these statements and many others, there are those who hold office as clergymen of the Church of England, who are not ashamed of circulating such a book as the ‘Eucharist Manual,’ in which it is said: ‘The Holy Eucharist is a true and substantial sacrifice offered to God the Father, offered for the quick and dead.’

Here, then, I may conclude. My object, let it be well remembered, has not been to discuss the subject from the Scriptures, but to ascertain the real teaching of the Church of England respecting it. Let it not be supposed for one moment that I have taken this position from any idea that there is any infallible rule of faith but God’s own Word as revealed in Scripture; but I have done so because the Church of England is at this present time sorely tried by internal difficulties, and it seems only due to her to ascertain with the utmost care what is the real character of her teaching. While some are loudly claiming her as teaching those very doctrines in opposition to which our Reformers went to the stake, and while others of a tender conscience

are forsaking her because they partially believe those bold statements to be true, it is of the utmost possible importance that those who are faithful to the Church of England should take the trouble to make themselves acquainted with her true principles. If it is a fact that she is identical with Rome, and that the Reformers were martyrs for a merely imaginary metaphysical distinction of no importance whatever; then, indeed, we may stand aghast at the ignorance and folly of all the theologians of all schools and all countries who have been weak enough to suppose that in the Reformation there was a doctrinal separation from the Apostasy of Rome. But if, on the other hand, the Reformers knew what they were doing, and why they did it; if they drew up these documents with the utmost care, and these documents so provoked the doctrinal antipathies of Rome, that while their authors were sacrificed at the stake their principles were branded by the anathemas of the Council of Trent; if none of our most thoughtful students for the last three centuries ever for one moment doubted that there was direct antagonism between the Church of England and that of Rome; then it is too sad to be borne that devout men, dearly beloved in the Lord, staunch to the great principles of the Gospel of the Grace of God, should have their consciences wounded, and their allegiance shaken, by the unproved assertions of men who, without any appeal to the Church's documents, claim to be the only expositors of its principles. It is moreover most deeply to be deplored that those who have a real, true, and faithful love for the Church of England should be led into error by the unproved assertion that the Church of England teaches that which she most emphatically denies. It is for the sake of both classes that I have been led to this investigation. If any are unsettled in their mind and disposed to distrust the Church of England, I shall rejoice if they are led to see how sound, how clear, and how perfectly Scriptural she is upon the subject. And if any have been led by mistaken ideas of the Church's teaching to hold opinions at variance with the great principles of the Reformation, I shall thank God more than I can express if they may be led to see what the Church which they love really teaches, that so the love of their Church may confirm them in the love of truth, and help to establish them as steady and consistent Churchmen in the faith once delivered to the saints.

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